Mid 18th Century (fragmented polity) #PYQ

During 16th–17th century, major parts of India gradually came under centralized administrative system with Mughal emperor at its apex.

Fragmented polity:

① Decline of Mughal empire ← Aurangzeb's misguided policies ⇒ internal weakness
⇓
State of Hyd. set up (1724)

② Nadir shah invasion (1739) ⇒ massacre of Delhi
further Abdali gained prominence

③ Emergence of regional states
- which broke away from Mughals ⇓ called as successor states (Hyd, Bengal etc.) (1746)
- new states by rebels against Mughals ⇓ Marathas, Sikhs, Jats
- independent states ⇓ Mysore, Rajputs, Kerala

These states along with Mughals and European powers were the elements in a fragmented polity.

This led to
Weaknesses:

① Lack of central authority = inter regional and intra regional wars
⇓
lack of stable polity = frequent wars.

② A generalised economic decline is seen
⇓ failure of trade, crops etc.
too many States = barriers in trade

Spectre:

① frequent wars and conflicts
⇓
both internal as well as external
⇓ ⇓
Marathas vs Mughals etc. — Ex: Nadir shah completely destroyed Delhi (1739)

② This led to death of soldiers and people.
⇓
further was fueled by taxation, loot of crops etc.
⇓
cities were also plundered

③ Social stagnation was also recorded
⇓
18th Century is called as Dark Age of India.

